Upcoming federal changes that affect Washington Apple Health for Adults Medicaid coverage.

You are receiving this letter because you or someone in your household is enrolled in Apple Health for Adults Medicaid coverage.

In July 2025, a new federal law, House Resolution 1 (H.R. 1) was passed by Congress and signed into law by President Donald Trump, making changes to Apple Health (Medicaid).

This new law makes changes to Apple Health for Adults coverage by:

- Adding work requirements to become or remain eligible for Apple Heath for Adults coverage. Work requirements are also known as community engagement requirements.
- Requiring health care coverage renewals every 6 months instead of every 12 months.

Work requirements do not apply to any other Apple Health (Medicaid) program. Children, American Indians/Alaska Natives (AI/AN), individuals who are pregnant or 12 months postpartum, individuals age 65 or older, and those who have a blindness or a disability do not need to meet work requirements.

When do these changes start?

Beginning January 1, 2027, individuals enrolled in Apple Health for Adults who do not meet a current-month exclusion need to meet work requirement activities or an exemption to keep their health care coverage.

These changes start at your first renewal in 2027. Before renewing coverage, you may need to show that you meet a current-month exclusion, work requirement activities, or an exemption in any one of the six months before renewing your coverage.

If you remain on Apple Health for Adults, you will have to renew your coverage every 6 months unless you are AI/AN.

What is Apple Health for Adults?

Apple Health for Adults is a Medicaid program for adults ages 19 to 64 who live in Washington, have household income under the limit for the program, and meet citizenship and immigration requirements.

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For more information about Apple Health for Adults, visit: **hca.wa.gov/individual-adults**.

How do I know if I have Apple Health for Adults?

Find your coverage type and renewal date:

- **Online:** wahealthplanfinder.org
    - View your most recent eligibility determination letter in the message center.
- **Phone:** 1-800-562-3022

Do I need to meet the work requirement activities or an exemption?

If you have Apple Health for Adults and do not meet one of the current-month exclusions, you must meet work requirement activities or an exemption to keep your health coverage.

What is a current-month exclusion?

When you have a current-month exclusion, you do not need to meet work requirement activities or an exemption. You meet a current-month exclusion if you are:

- Foster youth or former foster youth under age 26
- American Indian/Alaska Native (AI/AN) and certain Tribal populations
- A disabled veteran with 100% disability
- In treatment for alcohol or substance use disorder
- Meeting SNAP or TANF work requirement
- Incarcerated or 90-days post incarceration
- Medically frail
- A parent or caretaker of a child under 14 or of an individual of any age with a disability
- Pregnant or within 12 months postpartum

What are the new work requirement activities?

Work requirements are a new eligibility factor for Apple Health for Adults. You meet work requirements if in one month you have $580 in income, complete 80 hours of one or more work requirement activities, or a mix of these. Work requirement activities include:

- Working
- Volunteering
- Being enrolled in an educational program at least half-time
- Participating in a training or work program

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What are the exemptions to work requirements?

If you do not meet a current-month exclusion or meet work requirement activities, you may still be eligible for Apple Health for Adults by meeting an exemption. The exemptions are:

- Under age 19
- Entitled to Medicare Part A or B
- Experiencing a short-term hardship
- Enrolled in another Apple Health program that does not have work requirements

What is a short-term hardship?

A short-term hardship is an event that exempts you from meeting work requirement activities. You may have a short-term hardship if you are:

- Receiving inpatient or institutional care
- Travelling outside your community for medical care for yourself or a dependent
- Living in a county with a federal emergency or disaster declaration
- Living in a county with a high local unemployment rate

Where can I learn more about work requirements and exemptions?

For more information on work requirements, exemptions, and exclusions, visit: **hca.wa.gov/ah-work-req**.

What can I do if I lose coverage?

If you do not meet a current-month exclusion, work requirement activities, or an exemption, you may lose your Apple Health for Adults coverage. Before your coverage ends, we check to see if you can get other Apple Health coverage. You can reapply at any time.

If you lose your Apple Health for Adults coverage due to not meeting work requirements or an exemption, you will not be eligible for federal premium tax credits (PTC) or advanced premium tax credits (PTC) to help pay for coverage through a different program.

You can still enroll in a qualified health and dental plan with savings through Washington Healthplanfinder at **wahealthplanfinder.org**.

For help understanding your coverage options through Washington Healthplanfinder:

- **Online:** wahealthplanfinder.org/us/en/enrollment_support.html
- **Phone:** 1-855-923-4633

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What do I need to do now?

You will receive another notice when you need to start reporting work requirements. You can report how you meet work requirements starting in January 2027. For more information on reporting changes, visit: **hca.wa.gov/report-a-change**.

Where can I find more information?

Learn about work requirements, including community service opportunities by visiting **hca.wa.gov/ah-work-req**.

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